Weddings at St. Egbert's

Guidance for liturgical music selection



Congratulations on your big day! We offer many prayers for you for a lifetime of blessings and happiness.

For Catholics, a wedding is a *liturgical celebration* of the *sacrament of Holy Matrimony* (marriage), a sacrifice of two people becoming one in God. What is liturgy, you ask? Liturgy is at the heart of what the church does: it is our public worship of God, our creator. And what is worship? It is giving thanks and honor to God that is due to him for all he has given to us. It is our expression of honor, acknowledgement, and respect to and for God because he is greater than us in all ways.

Everything about the wedding liturgy, including the music, is about your worship of God and God alone. For this reason, the Church prohibits popular music of any kind within the liturgy. Liturgical music must be deliberate, appropriate, and "correspond to the spirit of the liturgical celebration itself" (*Instruction on Music in the Liturgy*, 9). To help you plan your worship of God at your wedding liturgy, we provide instructions and suitable music options below. Click on the title of any piece to listen to a sample recording.

We encourage you to use this web form to submit your choices. For questions or assistance, or if you would prefer to have us select your music for you, please reach out to Matt Grossi, music director and organist, at mgrossi@stegbert.org.

Processional

The entrance procession involves the couple's families (parents), wedding party, and the bride herself or the bride and groom together. You have a few options:

1. Sung processional hymn: Like at Mass, the hymn would be sung during the entire processional. **Choose one** from the list of processional hymns below.
   OR

2. One instrumental piece: Many couples opt for a single piece as a musical portrayal of familial unity. Pachelbel's *Canon in D* is a popular choice, with the slower movements played during the seating of families and bridal party and the faster climatic movement summoning the bride, but you may **choose any one piece** from the instrumental options below.
   OR

3. One instrumental piece for the seating of the families and the bridal party and a second piece for the bridal entrance. **Choose the first** one from the instrumental options and **the second** from either the instrumental options or the marches below.

Responsorial Psalm

Please **select one** Responsorial Psalm from the list below.

Preparation of Gifts

Select one hymn from the list of offertory hymn options below to be sung during the Preparation of Gifts. You may also opt to have instrumental music played instead. Omit this if you are not having a Mass.

Communion

Select one hymn from the list of communion hymn options below to be sung during the reception of Holy Communion. Omit this if you are not having a Mass.

Recessional

Select one recessional march from the list of marches below.

Hymns

The hymns and songs listed below are appropriate suggestions from the parish hymnal. Other suitable songs from the hymnal may be used upon request. The music director will determine suitability.

Processional Hymns

- 598: O God Beyond All Praising
- 601: Laudáte, Laudáte Dóminum
- 614: Joyful, Joyful, We Adore You
- 641: Love Divine, All Loves Excelling
- 969: Love Has Brought Us Here Together

Offertory Hymns

- 970: God, in the Planning
- 556: Come Down, O Love Divine
- 696: Ubi Cáritas (Hurd)
- 706: Where Charity and Love Prevail
- 708: Set Your Hearts on the Higher Gifts
- 709: Not for Tongues of Heaven's Angels
- 966: When Love is Found

Communion Hymns

- 931: Come to the Banquet
- 935: Draw Near
- 943: Bread of Life from Heaven
- 948: At the Table of Jesus
- 950: Take and Eat

Instrumentals

- Canon in D (Pachelbel)
- Jesu, Joy of Man's Desiring (Bach)
- Largo (Handel)
- Sheep May Safely Graze (Bach)

Marches

- Allegro Moderato (from Water Music) (Handel)
- Ode to Joy (Beethoven)
- Prelude to Te Deum (Charpentier)
- Thaxted (O God, Beyond All Praising) (Holst)
- Trumpet Tune (Purcell/Clarke)
- Trumpet Voluntary (Clarke)

Responsorial Psalms

- Psalm 33: The earth is full of the goodness of the Lord (Alstott)
- Psalm 34: Taste and see the goodness of the Lord (Alstott)
- Psalm 34: Taste and see the goodness of the Lord (Guimont)
- Psalm 103: The Lord is kind and merciful (Alstott)
- Psalm 103: The Lord is kind and merciful (Cotter)
- Psalm 128: Blessed are those who fear the Lord (Alstott)
- Psalm 128: Blest are those who love you (Haugen)
- Psalm 145: I will praise your name forever, my King and my God (Alstott)

Other Logistics

Wedding stipends for trained musicians are due at the start of ceremony:

- **Organist:** $200 (includes music coordination and playing the ceremony)
- **Cantor:** $150
- **Music rehearsal(s):** $50 each

Guest musicians, both cantors and instrumentalists, will be considered on a case-by-case basis, at the discretion of the music director and/or pastor. If you would like to include guest musicians, please indicate this in the form on the last question. All guest musicians must be both comfortable and experienced with the Catholic liturgy and will need to attend a music rehearsal with any parish musicians before the day of the wedding. (Note that this rehearsal is not the same as, nor can it occur at the same time as, the actual wedding rehearsal.) The music director may request an additional rehearsal if necessary to ensure the liturgy will flow smoothly. While every attempt will be made to welcome and include guest musicians, the music director and pastor both reserve the right to exclude anyone deemed too uncomfortable with the liturgy or incapable of meeting the standards of a liturgical musician.

Requests for liturgical music *not* in the parish hymnal will be considered on a case-by-case basis, at the discretion of the music director. If you would like a particular piece to be considered, please provide the name, composer, and, if possible, a link to a YouTube video in

the form on the last question. If the piece is deemed appropriate but St. Egbert Church does not have a license to use it, the couple is responsible for purchasing the sheet music and rights to perform in advance of the wedding. (These usually go hand-in-hand, and costs are typically nominal, but be sure to verify when purchasing.) Keep in mind that musicians (accompanist and cantor) may need ample time to practice unfamiliar pieces, so please plan accordingly.

> "The marriage covenant, by which a man and a woman form with each other an intimate communion of life and love, has been founded and endowed with its own special laws by the Creator." (*On the Church in the Modern World*, 48)